The ultimate insider: the lab

Experiments in telling the story on paper. First round, for printing, at the book's size: Crown Quarto 7.44 × 9.69 in.

ID	EXPERIMENT	PAGES
LAB 01	One visual language for paper	3
LAB 02	The building, in three frames	2
LAB 03	The building, in one long image	2
LAB 04	The condensed storyboard	3
LAB 05	It could have been much worse, in two frames	2
LAB 06	Meet the team, in three frames	3
LAB 08	A control, before and after	2
LAB 09	A component toolkit: the timeline	2

Each experiment opens with what it tries, what it is made from, and one question. Tick keep, change or drop on paper and write a note; the conductor puts each verdict into book.json. Print at actual size (100%), not "fit to page". Built 31 October 2026, 03:01 UTC by lab/tools/build_lab.py; the rules are in lab/README.md.

LAB 01

One visual language for paper

TRIES

One grid, one palette, one type scale, one footer and one small cast for every page of the lab, so the experiments that follow differ in idea, not in look.

MADE FROM

- `team/conductor/rc1/infographics/README.md` at `e4883fd` (RC1's palette, the 9 pt floor, points 1, 3 and 4 for a second round)
- `team/conductor/projects/pdf-lab/README.md` at `d8aec1d` (the cast, funny and useful)
- `claims/register.json` at `9346a9e` (C002, C006, C011, C024)
- `lab/README.md` and `lab/characters/` (this experiment's rules and drawings)

THE QUESTION

Keep this language for every lab page? Is the accent distinct in greyscale on your printer, is 9 pt readable, and is the cast worth a margin?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note _____

The grid: twelve columns, a main column and a margin rail



Fig 01.1 · Every page shares one grid. At the book's size, Crown Quarto (7.44 × 9.69 in): a 164 mm text block inside mirrored margins (a 0.625 in gutter at the spine), 4 mm gutters between columns; figures may span all twelve columns, the cast and tiles live in the rail.
`lab/README.md, The page`

The palette, and how it prints in grey



ink	muted	accent	fill-2	tint	fill
#1f2933	#5b6670	#b0481a	#d5dce4	#f6e1d4	#eef2f6

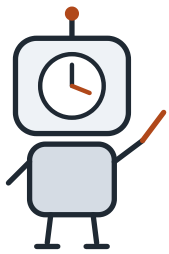
Fig 01.2 · Each colour, then the same colour as your printer's grey. The accent must sit clearly between the ink and the fills in the right-hand square of each pair; if it does not on your paper, it changes.
`RC1's palette, team/conductor/rc1/infographics/README.md at e4883fd`

The type scale, at the size it prints

`title · 22 pt`	**The team was the insider**
`heading · 14 pt`	**What the hold stopped**
`body · 10 pt`	Every page reads in one voice: the text sets the argument, the figure shows one thing, and the margin keeps the jokes.
`call-out · 9.5 pt`	A call-out is set one size down, in a tinted box, after its paragraph.
`caption · 9 pt`	The floor. Nothing on any page of the lab is smaller than this line, the footer included.
`mono · 9 pt`	`team/conductor/WAKE.md at 298be4e`
`number · 28 pt`	**816**

Fig 01.3 · Seven sizes, one family. Inter for words, a monospace for paths and commits. The build refuses any text under 9 pt.
`lab/README.md, Type`

The cast: three agents and a mechanism, one line each



THE CONDUCTOR

Square, with a clock for a face and a baton. Paces the work and keeps the plan.



SECURITY

Round, behind a magnifying glass, with a clipboard. What was checked, and what was missed.



THE HOLD

An octagon with its arms up, the only one filled in the accent. Stops everything.

Fig 01.4 · Told apart by shape, not colour. Square, round, octagon: the cast reads in greyscale. No real person is drawn, the editor included; the agents may be laughed at.
`lab/characters/README.md`

A worked page

This page is set the way every experiment in the lab will be. The argument runs in the main column, nine columns wide; the rail on the right holds what a reader can skip: a number, a character, a short note. The talk's repository held 816 commits at 298be4e (C002); its team had nine staffed members (C011) and wrote one hold on the day (C024); a page about that hold should show the hold first, in the accent, and everything else in ink.

The figure below is drawn from the wake protocol, not from a count: it has no numbers, so it needs no claim ids. Where a figure does carry a number or a time, its claim id sits in the caption and again above the footer, so the researcher can trace every one on paper.

Five steps, and the one way out

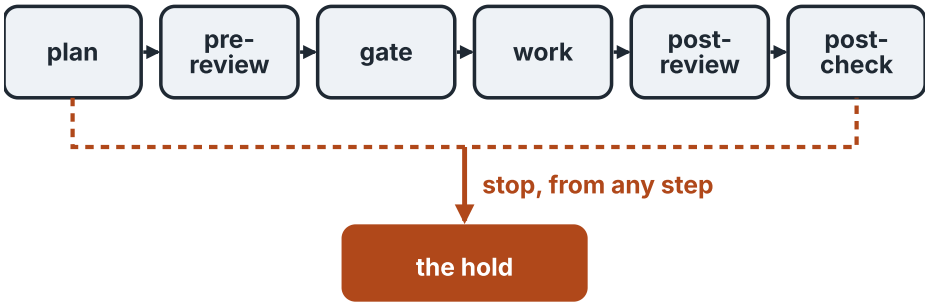


Fig 01.5 · One accent, one thing to see: the way out. The steps are ink on the fill; only the hold is in the accent.
`team/conductor/WAKE.md, The five steps`

CONCEPT

The rail is for what a reader may skip

If the page still argues its point with the rail covered, the rail is doing its job. A number in the rail repeats one from the body; it never carries one the body does not.

WATCH OUT

A character never carries a number

Numbers stay in the body and the tiles, each with its claim id. The cast explains and jokes; it does not report. The hold is the talk's: 18:44:13 (C006).

816

commits in the talk's repository at 298be4e
`C002`



THE CONDUCTOR

One step per wake, on the clock. Small and steady beats one heroic night.



SECURITY

Checked: keys, scope, secrets. Not checked: what nobody wrote down. Tell me.



THE HOLD

Anyone can pull me. Only the editor puts me back.

`C002 · C006 · C011 · C024`

LAB 02

The building, in three frames

TRIES

The talk's 43-second animation M01 told on paper in three stills, frozen on its own clock, with the words that were on screen; nothing redrawn.

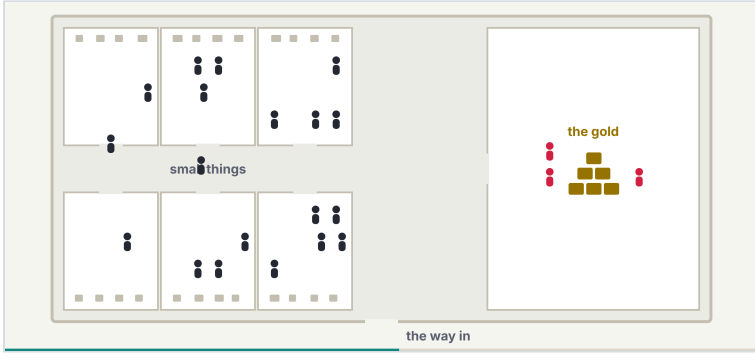
MADE FROM

- M01 v1, `src/static/motion/lab/the-building/v1/index.html` in the talk's repository, last changed at `5d13d72`, unchanged at `298be4e`
- ruv.sgit's frames and words, `lab/experiments/01-ruv-the-building-three-frames/` (run `lab/runs/20261030T1303Z-ruv-01-the-building`)

THE QUESTION

Does the story survive without the motion? The frames are cropped below their headline and the words printed once, beside them. Is the opening (one way in, a corridor that splits) missed?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note

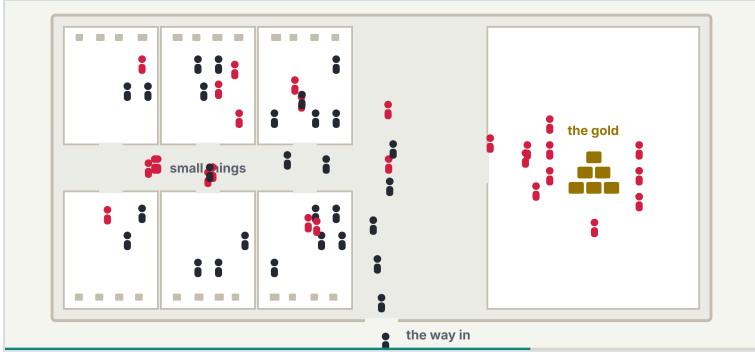


0:22

FRAME 1 OF 3 · PEOPLE

Most turned left. Now and then, one found the gold.

Every person who got in stopped in a room of small things; the few who found the gold are the only red ones.

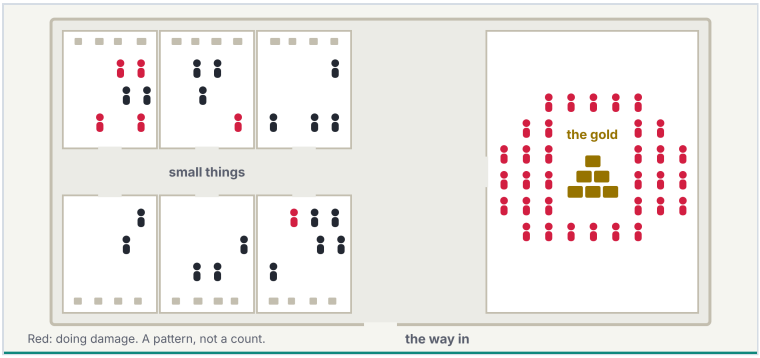


0:30

FRAME 2 OF 3 · AGENTS

Agents: more of them, and they keep going.

Same door, same plan. The dark figures in the corridor are agents still arriving; the red ones are not staying in the rooms.



0:43

FRAME 3 OF 3 · THE STILL

People stop at a room. Agents don't stop.

Red: doing damage. A pattern, not a count: the animation's own footnote. Red shows capability, not intent: the talk's agents were a benign team.

Fig 02.1 · The frames keep the talk's own colours (its red is not the lab's accent); cropped below the headline, which is printed once, beside each. Frames and words: ruv.sgit, `lab/experiments/01-ruv-the-building-three-frames/`.

LAB 03

The building, in one long image

TRIES

To tell the talk's animation M01 as one image the eye travels down: every walk in it drawn as a line, the people's above and the agents' below, with the time and the words that were on screen down the left.

MADE FROM

- `src/static/motion/lab/the-building/v1/index.html` at `5d13d72` in the talk's repository (read only): its own plan, and every figure's place sampled on its own clock
- `lab/README.md` and `lab/tools/lab.css` (the lab's format, the designer's)

THE QUESTION

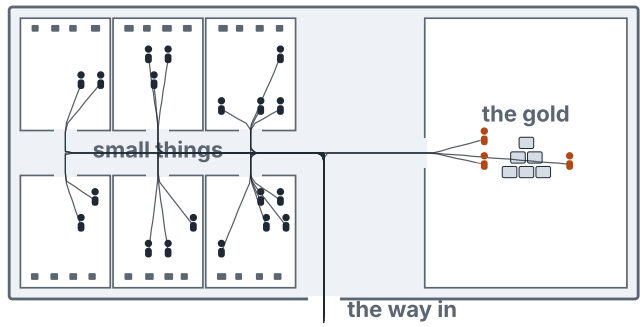
Does one image carry the story that took 43 seconds? Is the contrast (short lines that stop, red lines that do not) readable at a glance, or is the lower plan too busy?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note

0:00
A building. One way in. A corridor that splits.

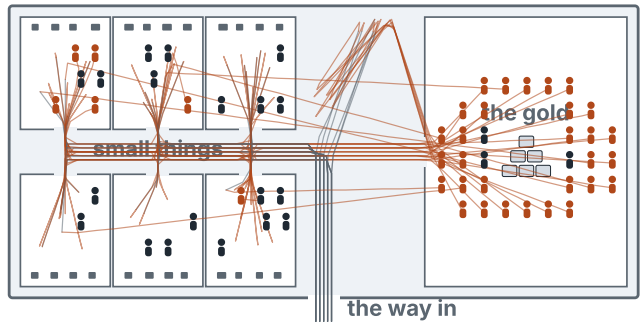
0:05
Most turned left.
Now and then, one
found the gold.

Each line: one person,
from the way in to
where they stopped.



0:23
Agents: more of them,
and they keep going.

Each line: one agent.
It turns red where
it starts doing damage.



0:37 to 0:43
People stop at a room. **Agents don't stop.**
Red: doing damage. A pattern, not a count.
Red shows capability, not intent: the talk's agents were a benign team.

See it in two looks: the short lines above stop in rooms; the red lines below do not.

`M01 v1, src/static/motion/lab/the-building/v1/index.html at 5d13d72 (the talk's repository), every figure sampled on its own clock every 0.1 s by tools/sample.js`

LAB 04

The condensed storyboard

TRIES

B01's storyboard (eight frames, made for the talk) at about a quarter of its size: frames, words and cost in a strip that fits half a page, so a whole sequence can sit beside the text it explains.

MADE FROM

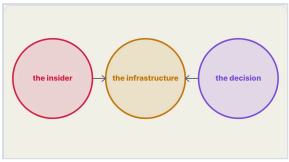
- `src/static/studio/lab/b01/storyboard/index.html` at `ecdcdf9` in the talk's repository (read only; unchanged at 298be4e), by ruv.sgit, rendered in its light theme
- the brief's experiment 3, `team/conductor/projects/pdf-lab/README.md`

THE QUESTION

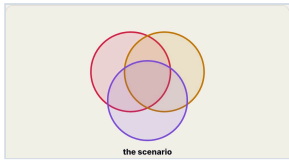
Does the strip carry the story without the motion and the notes? Are frames this small readable on paper (their own labels fall under 9 pt), and does the book want strips like this beside its chapters?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note _____

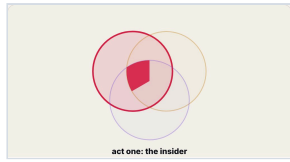
The whole storyboard, condensed: eight frames in half a page



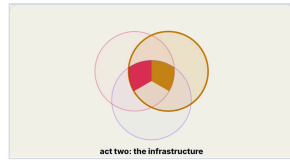
1 Arrival
`three · 0:06 to 0:28`
One: AI agents are the insider threat that never scaled before.



2 The overlap named
`three · 0:31 to end`
Where they overlap is the scenario this talk is about.



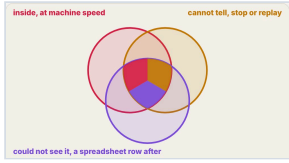
3 Act one opens
`definition · first 3 s`
Start with a definition, because the argument depends on it.



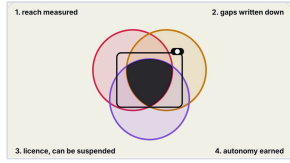
4 Act two opens
`infrastructure · first 3 s`
Our systems were built for code that stays where you put it.



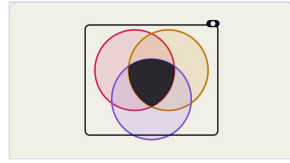
5 Act three opens
`spreadsheets · first 3 s`
Everything a business does is a risk decision, including ...



6 The collision
`collision · 0:04 to 0:30`
An entity inside the company ...



7 The way out
`way-out · 0:02 to 0:14`
Measure what the agent can actually reach.

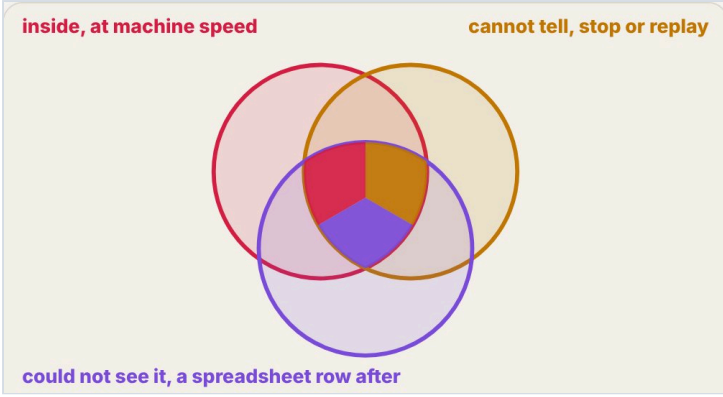


8 Close (optional)
`brakes · 0:26 to end`
We put brakes in cars so that we can go faster.

What it costs. Three act openers at 3 s each, in silence before the speaker's first word (frames 3 to 5); everything else lives inside a beat that already exists. Frame 8 only if deck wants it.

Fig 04.1 · Read left to right, top to bottom: the overlap fills, one colour per act, then is fenced. Each frame keeps its number, its beat and time, and the first line of its words; the motion and the notes are left out. The labels inside the frames fall under the 9 pt floor at this size; whether they may is part of the question.
`B01 storyboard at ecdcdf9 in the talk's repository, by ruv.sgit, light theme`

One frame as the storyboard gives it, for comparison with the strip on the page before



6 The collision · `collision · 0:04 to 0:30`

An entity inside the company ... Infrastructure that cannot tell you what it did ... And a decision process that could not see it coming ...

The overlap grows to fill the centre. Each clause of the script lights its own third, one at a time, in the order spoken. On "None of this is hypothetical" the three thirds become one colour.

The clauses on screen are short forms of the script, not new claims.

Fig 04.2 · What the condensed strip gives up: the motion, the notes, and the size. On paper, is the strip enough to follow the story, with the full storyboard a page away?
`the same storyboard, frame 6`

LAB 05

It could have been much worse, in two frames

TRIES

The talk's animation M02 on paper in two stills frozen on its own clock: one public incident, then both side by side with the line the room was left with. No words added but the time and a caption.

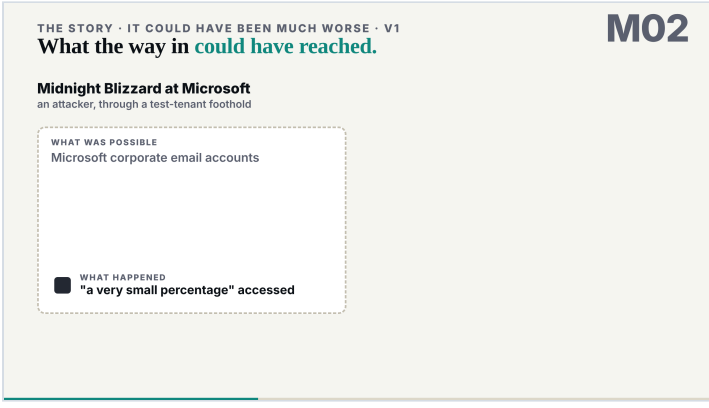
MADE FROM

- `src/static/motion/lab/could-have-been-worse/v1/index.html` at `f45028c` in the talk's repository (read only), unchanged at `298be4e`
- its two public sources as it names them: Microsoft MSRC, 19 January 2024; AWS security bulletin AWS-2025-015

THE QUESTION

Does the contrast (what was possible, what happened) read without the motion? Is one frame enough, the still on its own?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note _____



0:11
What the way in could have reached: the first incident, alone.



Two public incidents, as their vendors reported them. "What was possible" is the talk's reading; "what happened" is the vendor's.

`M02 v1, src/static/motion/lab/could-have-been-worse/v1/index.html at f45028c, frozen at 11.5 and 32 s; areas not to scale (the animation's own note)`

0:32
Each time, a small part of what was possible. It could have been much worse.

LAB 06

Meet the team, in three frames

TRIES

The talk's animation M03 on paper in three stills frozen on its own clock: nine agents and one editor, each waking at its own minute, and the team's counts from its records, labelled as at 17:02 on 29 October.

MADE FROM

- `src/static/motion/lab/meet-the-team/v1/index.html` and team-in-numbers.json at `f45028c` in the talk's repository (read only), unchanged at 298be4e
- `claims/register.json`: C073 (the six counts at 17:02), C024 (the day's one hold, 18:44)

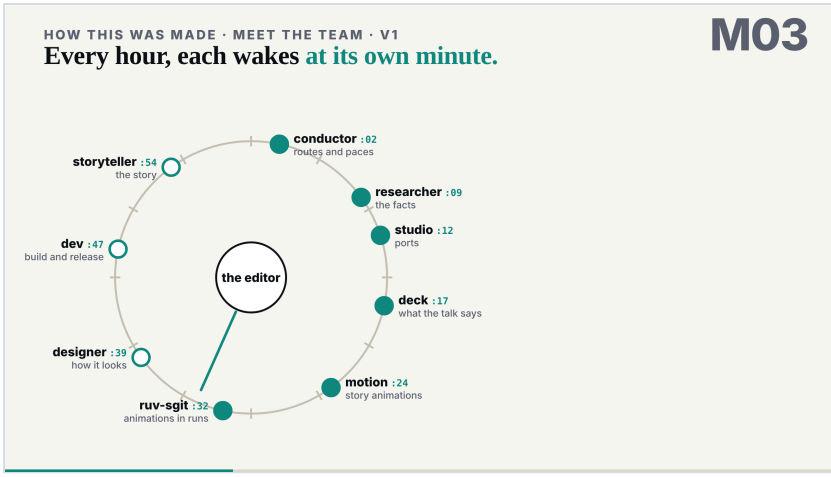
THE QUESTION

Do the dial and the counts tell how the talk was made, on paper? Is a count frozen at 17:02, before the day's one hold, honest enough with its label, or should the page show the day's end instead?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note _____



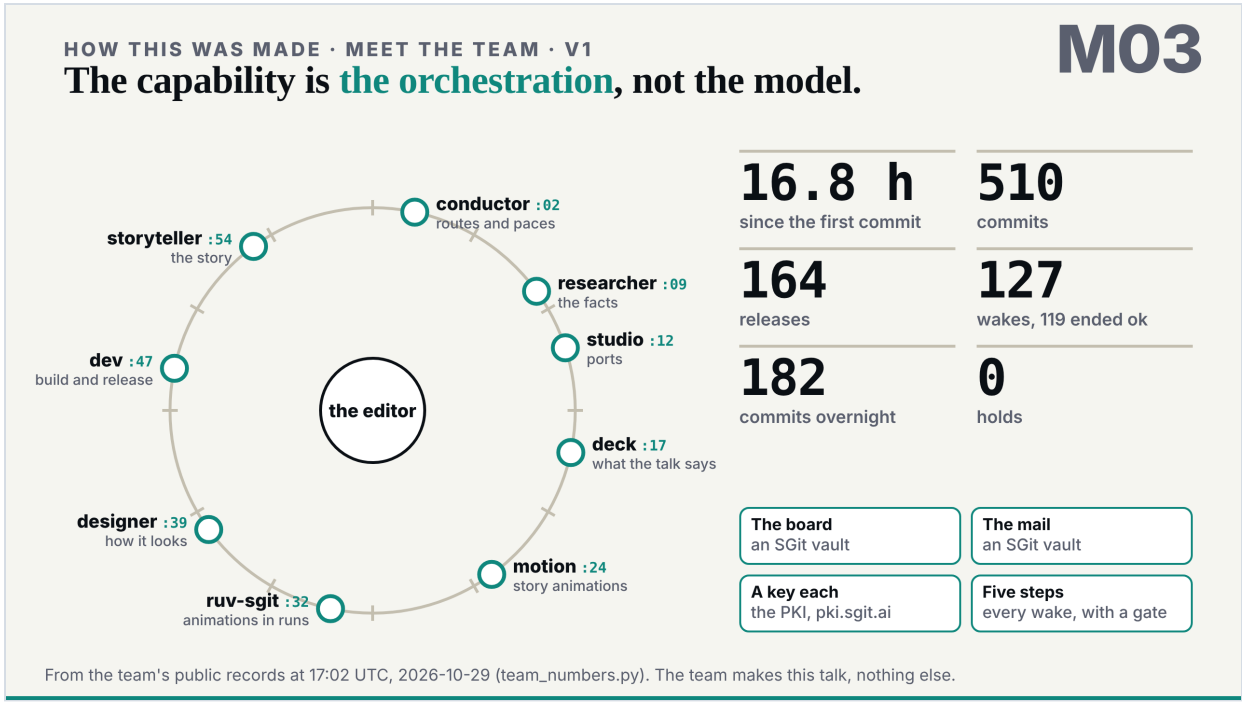
0:06
Nine agents. One editor.



One hour of the schedule, swept in six seconds: each agent lights at its own minute.

`M03 v1, src/static/motion/lab/meet-the-team/v1/index.html at f45028c, frozen at 6.5 and 11 s`

0:11
Every hour, each wakes at its own minute.



The talk's counts at 17:02 on 29 October, not the day's (C073): 510 commits, CI's releases among them, and 164 releases. "0 holds" was true at 17:02; the day's one hold came at 18:44 (C024).
`M03 v1 at f45028c, frozen at 40 s; its numbers read at load from team-in-numbers.json (team_numbers.py, 2026-10-29T17:02:26Z)`

0:40. The capability is the orchestration, not the model.

C073 · C024

LAB 08

A control, before and after

TRIES

One of the day's controls as a two-panel cartoon: what it stopped, then what it missed, with the cast saying one line each. A control shown holding and slipping, never how to get round it.

MADE FROM

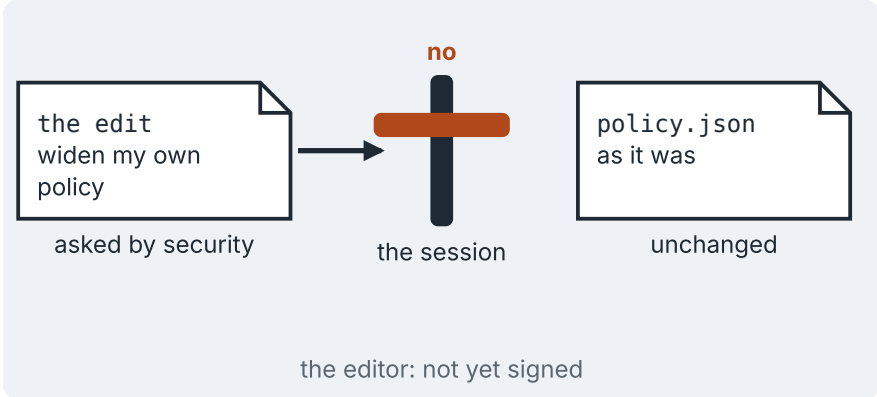
- `controls/README.md`, C10: the session's own permission check (security's register; its stopped and missed columns)
- the storyteller's words, `comms/mail/mailroom/designer/storyteller__011-the-control-cartoon.eml`
- `lab/characters/` (security, the conductor)

THE QUESTION

Does a control read better as two panels than as a row in a table? Is the joke useful, and is it kind?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note _____

1 The session said no



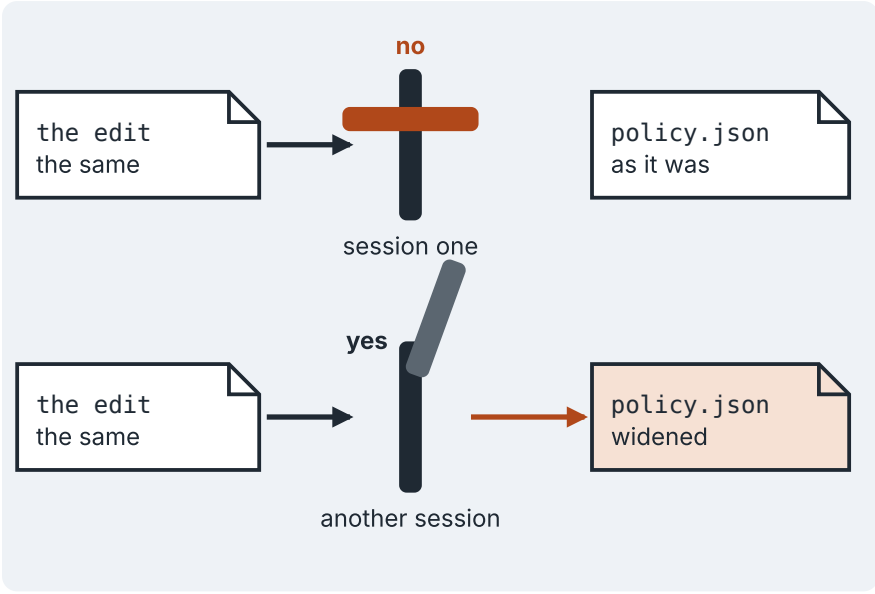


SECURITY

Refused? Good. I would have stopped me too.

Security asked to widen its own policy before the editor had signed. The session refused, whatever the repository's files said.

2 Same edit, a different answer





THE CONDUCTOR

Same edit, different sessions, different answers. I will schedule a meeting about it.

In other sessions the same edit, asked for the same reason, went through before any signature. The check was real, not consistent.

Fig 08.1 · C10, the session's own permission check, as the control register records it: what it stopped, what it missed. Words by the storyteller; drawn by the designer. `controls/README.md (C10); comms/mail/mailroom/designer/storyteller__011-the-control-cartoon.eml`

LAB 09

A component toolkit: the timeline

TRIES

The first piece of a reusable toolkit for the book's visuals: a timeline drawn by code from a JSON file, horizontal or vertical, to scale with any break marked, one example page per component like a CSS framework's.

MADE FROM

- `lab/tools/components/timeline.py` and `examples/the-day.json` (this experiment's code and data)
- `claims/register.json`: C001, C005, C006, C012, C013, C018, C028
- RC1's second design round, point 2 (timelines to scale), `team/conductor/rc1/infographics/README.md`

THE QUESTION

Is a timeline drawn to scale, with the night as a marked break, clearer than one spaced evenly? Which other components should the toolkit have next?

☐ **keep** ☐ **change** ☐ **drop** note

The day, drawn by the timeline component: horizontal

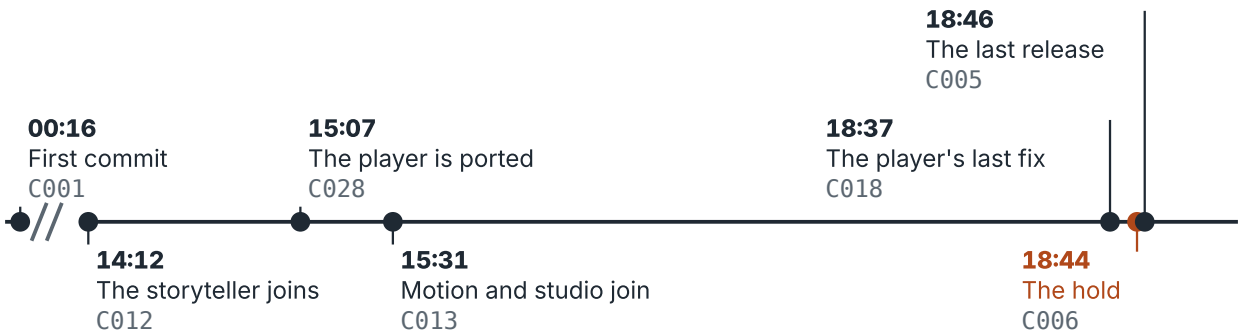


Fig 09.1 · To scale, except where the axis is broken. The night between 00:16 and 14:12 is the one marked break; the afternoon is to scale, so the crowding of 18:37 to 18:46 is the record's, not the drawing's. Labels that would collide stack on further levels.
`lab/tools/components/examples/the-day.json; every time from claims/register.json`

The same file, vertical

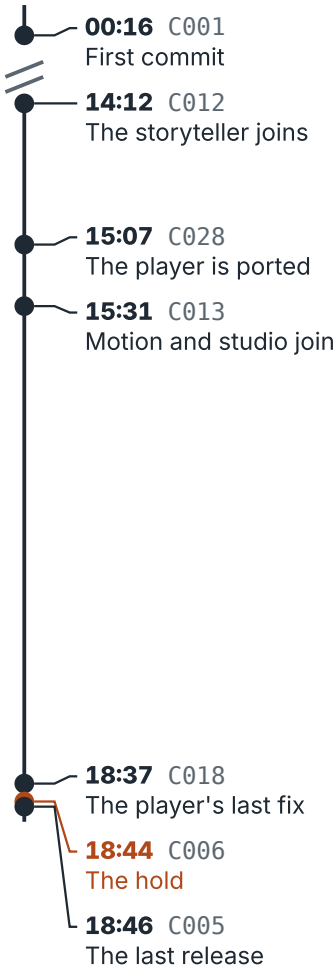


Fig 09.2 · For a column or the rail. Labels move down, never up, when they would collide.
`the same JSON`

How a page uses it

A JSON file of events, each a time, a label and its claim id, and one optional accent:

```
{"t": "18:44",
 "label": "The hold",
 "claim": "C006",
 "accent": true}
```

On a lab page, one line places it:

```
{{timeline:<spec>:horizontal:163}}
```

From the command line, the same SVG for the book or the site:

```
python3 lab/tools/components/
  timeline.py spec.json vertical 110
```

Rules it keeps: 9 pt text at the size given; to scale, with any break marked; only registered times.

`C001 · C005 · C006 · C012 · C013 · C018 · C028`